Krishna Upadhyaya

Protocol & Solutions Engineer

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Blockchain engineer with 9+ years of experience, from client delivery to Polygon's core protocol and founding engineer roles. I build infrastructure and product features, and I work directly with developers and users to understand their problems and solve them.

EXPERIENCE

Founding Protocol Engineer (Contract)
Sep 2025 – Nov 2026

Pelagos Network · Remote

- Worked directly with teams building on the Pelagos SDK and with users of Nabu, Pelagos's AI trading platform, turning their issues and requirements into shipped fixes and features.
- Built Go SDK features for appchain developers, including transaction receipts, JSON-RPC, external transactions, and Solana and EVM support, and maintained the public example appchain.
- Integrated live exchanges into Nabu, including Binance spot and perps and Hyperliquid markets, with leverage and native take-profit and stop-loss orders.
- Reworked profit-and-loss and portfolio reporting so that account figures come from the exchange as the single source of truth, across the backend, API and UI.
- Extended the core protocol with Midnight chain integration, exchange market data, and storage reclamation.
- Built a testnet L1-to-L2 bridge appchain on the SDK in Go and Solidity (github.com/0xKrishna/bridge).

Blockchain Protocol Lead
Feb 2024 – Aug 2025

Independent Consultant · Remote

- Architected a modular dApp ecosystem on OP Stack, deploying each application as its own customizable rollup.
- Built a rollup orchestrator to automate deployment, contract initialization and lifecycle management through an API and UI.
- Connected rollups to a decentralized sequencer network built with Cosmos SDK, enabling shared block production and wallet balances.
- Implemented cross-chain messaging with Hyperlane and integrated private on-chain compute using Zama's FHE coprocessor.

Senior Protocol Engineer
Jan 2021 – Jan 2024

Polygon Labs · Remote

- Maintained and enhanced core Polygon PoS components, including Heimdall (Cosmos SDK) and Bor (Geth-derived) nodes.
- Led development of Turbo-Bor, an Erigon fork that was later merged upstream so that Erigon supports Bor consensus natively.
- Designed and implemented the Bor-Heimdall merged binary, simplifying node operations and deployment.
- Led multiple network hard forks covering security patches and feature rollouts.
- Built a self-healing mechanism in Heimdall so that nodes recover automatically from missed events and validator downtime.

Associate Team Lead
Aug 2020 – Jan 2021

Senior Solutions Engineer
Aug 2019 – Jul 2020

Solutions Engineer
Jul 2017 – Jul 2019

Deqode · Pune, India

- Delivered full-stack blockchain solutions across multiple client engagements, progressing to team lead.
- Monetha: built a Go backend and React frontend, with Ethereum integration for ERC-20 payments.
- CakeDefi: developed TypeScript microservices and implemented Bitcoin and Ethereum wallet operations.
- 0chain: designed and built a proprietary blockchain in Go, including REST APIs, CLI tools and node orchestration.

SKILLS

Languages: Go, TypeScript, JavaScript, Solidity, React

Protocol: Consensus and node infrastructure, Polygon PoS (Bor, Heimdall), Erigon, Go-Ethereum, Cosmos SDK, OP Stack

Cross-chain and integrations: Hyperlane, bridges, Solana, Midnight, JSON-RPC, WebSockets, webhooks, Privy wallets

Trading systems: Hyperliquid, Binance, perps, order lifecycle, PnL

Infrastructure: Docker, MDBX, SQL, WebAssembly

EDUCATION

B.E., Information Technology, Pune Institute of Computer Technology. First Class with Distinction — 2013 – 2017